

Writing to analyze or review

THESE TWO TYPES OF WRITING BREAK DOWN A TOPIC AND DISCUSS ITS KEY PARTS.

Both an analysis and a review discuss a subject in depth. However, while an analysis gives a balanced judgement, a review is usually opinionated and personal.

Balanced judgment

An analysis is an investigation of a topic. Unlike a persuasive piece of writing or a review, an analysis remains objective, which means that it is not influenced by personal feelings. It will look at the good and bad points of a subject, and come to a fair conclusion. A useful way to plan a balanced analysis is to use a table, listing arguments for and against.

Against reality television	For reality television
Television producers make shows vulgar and offensive in order to boost ratings.	Reality television is popular and producers should give viewers what they want.
It encourages people to pursue celebrity status, rather than success through education and hard work.	If someone doesn't want to watch a show, they can change the channel or turn off the television.
The contestants are humiliated and treated poorly, which sets a bad example for viewers.	Some shows tackle important problems in society, such as unhealthy eating.
All the shows follow the same formula, and no creativity is involved in the making of a program.	Reality television tells us more about human nature, and how people behave in certain situations.

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GLOSSARY

First person narrative When an author writes a piece from his or her point of view, using *I* and *my*.

Objective When a piece of writing is not influenced by personal opinions.

Subjective When a piece of writing is influenced by personal opinions.

Third person narrative When an author writes from a detached or outside point of view.

Distant and detached

To maintain the objectivity of an analysis, it's best to write in the third person and use an impersonal tone. For example, starting a sentence with the words *It is often argued* does not reveal the writer's personal opinion.

It is often argued...

It seems likely...

There is evidence to suggest...

Many people believe...

It is sometimes stated...